Garrett Spear

AI CYBERSECURITY ENGINEER PRINCIPAL

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Principal-level SME driving AI-maturity, cyber engineering, SOC automation, and innovative security workflow design across multi-tenant managed security environments, applying MBA-informed service strategy and operational efficiency to enhance security outcomes and customer value.

HIGHLIGHTS

3 Degrees

4 Active Organizations

10 Certifications

10 Years in Cybersecurity

20 Years in the workforce

KEY FOCUS AREAS

Agentic AI Foundations
Vulnerability Assessment
Security Automation
Detection Engineering
Threat Intel Enrichment
MSSP Operations
Web Design
Cloud-native Microservices
AI Ops Integration

CORE TOOLS

Splunk Enterprise
Qualys
Crowdstrike
AWS Cloud

SUMMARY

Principal-level cybersecurity engineer with nearly 10 years in MSSP/SOC environments (all at GDIT), specializing in detection engineering, analytic operations, security automation, and threat intelligence enrichment. Design and operate SIEM workflows, enrichment pipelines, adaptive response actions, and orchestration patterns that prepare organizations to integrate LLMs and agentic AI into threat detection, investigation, and vulnerability-aware defense. Combines deep technical execution with MBA-level business acumen, aligning security engineering, automation, and platform design with service strategy, operational efficiency, and customer value.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

(Enterprise) AI Cybersecurity Engineer Principal — January 2026 - Present

General Dynamics Information Technology • Security Operations and Tools Manager

AI-Fluent | Automation | Cloud | Customer Outcomes | Security | Service Strategy | Management

- Led end-to-end Security Operations Center (SOC) and Managed Security Tools (MST) operations, ensuring 24/7/365 monitoring, assessement, and incident response coverage.
- Directed a multidisciplinary team of cybersecurity analysts and engineers to deliver real-time threat detection, investigation, and escalation management across ~4,000 managed assets for government customers.
- Managed SOC performance metrics, operational SLAs/OLAs, and continuous improvement processes leveraging automation, threat intelligence, and data-driven dashboards.
- Oversaw vulnerability management operations using Qualys VMDR to deliver continuous scanning, compliance tracking, and prioritized remediation workflows across TSS-managed environments.
- Directed lifecycle management and optimization of enterprise security stack technologies including Splunk, CrowdStrike, and Qualys, improving detection fidelity and reducing false positives.
- Championed SOC modernization initiatives leveraging AI/ML-enabled threat detection, real-time data ingestion, and automated playbooks to accelerate incident response and improve operational efficiency.
- Served as Delivery Lead for Managed Endpoint Vulnerability & Detection (MST), coordinating cross-functional engineering, operations, and customer stakeholders to ensure mission alignment.
- Contribute subject matter expertise to solutions architecture efforts for new and evolving customer programs, including SOC design, platform build-out, tool integration, and security advisory support.
- Collaborated across Technology Shared Services (TSS), Cyber Engineering, and ACIC Cyber Solutions teams to standardize escalation paths, streamline processes, and reinforce a unified enterprise cyber defense posture.

(SMB) Director — Technology & Market Strategy — Oct 2025 – Present

Revelation Escapes Ministry • 501(c)(3) Nonprofit Organization

Business Operations | Market Analysis | Process Optimization | Service Design

- Direct operational strategy and internal processes for a nonprofit entertainment and community-oriented venue, emphasizing customer experience quality, service flow optimization, and operational reliability.

ChatGPT / Claude | Git + Github

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

AWS AI Practitioner (in progress)
Splunk Cybersecurity Defense Engineer
Splunk Cybersecurity Defense Analyst
Splunk Enterprise Security Admin
Splunk Advanced Power User
CrowdStrike Falcon Administrator

Vendor-neutral
ISC2 CISSP (in progress)
CompTIA CySA+ CE
CompTIA Network+ CE
CompTIA Security+ CE
CompTIA CASP+ CE (expired)
ITIL 4 Foundations
NSA CNSSI Certificate of Senior Systems Manager

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration - Entrepreneurship
Louisiana State University Shreveport
Class of 2026 – Graduate

B.S., Computer Networking & Cybersecurity
University of Maryland Global Campus
Class of 2021 – Graduate

A.A.S., Network Security
Bossier Parish Community College
Class of 2017 – Graduate

TECHNICAL SKILL AREAS

Security & Automation
Splunk ES/SOAR, Crowdstrike, Qualys, correlation searches, risk-based alerting, IOC enrichment, adaptive response actions, workflow actions, cyber threat intel integration/automation, detection tuning, Swagger OpenAPIv3.1, OPA policies

Languages & Platforms
SPL (Splunk), RegEx, JSON, YAML, Terraform, Git, HTML/CSS, JavaScript/Node, Python, PowerShell, Bash, Linux, Windows, Docker, GitHub, HTTP/REST APIs, Google Cloud (GCP), Amazon Web Services (AWS), Terraform

- Conduct structured market analysis to identify local demand, competitive positioning, pricing strategies, and opportunities for differentiated service offerings aligned with the organization's mission.
- Evaluate throughput, capacity planning, and staffing models to support peak-hour scheduling, resource utilization, and operational efficiency.
- Guide the improvement of customer-facing digital experiences, including website structure, lead-capture flows, and SEO-aligned enhancements.
- Support financial decision-making by analyzing revenue patterns, cost structures, and operational data to recommend improvements aligned with nonprofit stewardship principles.
- Identify opportunities for workflow automation, data-informed decision support, and streamlined management practices based on MBA coursework and service design strategy.

(SMB) Solution Architect/Engineer — Platform R&D
May 2025 – Present

VulnServer Labs LLC (owner)

AI-Fluent | Automation | Business & Strategy | Cloud | DevOps | Market Analysis | Security | Service Design | Web App

- Architect and engineer a cloud-native cybersecurity lab and ethical hacking platform focused on automation, multi-tenant workloads, frontend and backend development, and an AI-assistant service.
- Designed an event-driven orchestration system using AWS Amplify, Lambda, API Gateway, EC2/ECS, DynamoDB, S3, CloudFront, and SES to manage provisioning, lifecycle control, and environment teardown.
- Developed structured YAML API specifications aligned with OpenAPI-style contract principles to standardize service interactions and ensure reliable frontend–backend integration.
- Built Terraform-based infrastructure-as-code modules to automate deployment, ephemeral lab environment creation, key management, and destruction of short-lived workloads.
- Implemented a secure magic-link authentication workflow using signed tokens, session fingerprints, and cookie-bound controls to prevent unauthorized access and link sharing.
- Integrated Stripe checkout with backend automation to generate session metadata, trigger lab provisioning events, and enforce time-bound (8-hour) environment lifecycles.
- Developed backend structures to support future LLM-assisted evaluation, including scoring rubrics, model-selection logic, and structured data pipelines for AI-driven feedback.
- Created vulnerable applications and simulated exploitation paths (SQLi, authentication flaws, chained attack vectors) to support detection engineering and analyst training.
- Built a secure full-stack web interface for lab access and control, implementing modular TypeScript/JavaScript UI components, authentication flows, interactive dashboards, and real-time status polling.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions for automated testing, build generation, artifact packaging, S3/CloudFront deployments, versioning, and cache invalidation to support rapid iteration.
- Defined service positioning, pricing concepts, and academic/enterprise integration scenarios, using MBA coursework and market analysis to align platform capabilities with target customer segments and sustainable operations.

(Enterprise) Cybersecurity Engineer Principal
Sep 2024 – January 2026

General Dynamics Information Technology • Principal Detection Engineer (Lead IC)

AI-Ready | Automation | Cloud | Customer Outcomes | Security | Service Strategy | Splunk

- Lead analytic engineering for a multi-tenant Splunk ES deployment, including correlation searches, data models, and risk logic for managed security customers.
- Built API-driven enrichment workflows integrating AbuseIPDB, VirusTotal, and other OSINT sources for search-time and alert-time enrichment.
- Developed workflow actions and adaptive response actions in Splunk ES and custom apps to automate enrichment and hand-off to SOAR pipelines.
- Developed API-driven enrichment and automation patterns, integrating external threat intelligence sources and Splunk ES adaptive response actions into SOC workflows.
- Designed foundations for agentic, AI-assisted SOC workflows, including orchestration patterns and session-based enrichment structures to support future LLM integration.
- Created dashboards and operational reports that expose coverage, alert quality, and threat trends for MSSP customers, supporting leadership decision-making and service improvement.
- Led high-risk triage, guided incident response, and supported threat hunting across multi-tenant environments.
- Contributed to technical solution design and strategic modernization proposals for cyber operations and automation initiatives, aligning engineering efforts with business goals and customer expectations.

(Enterprise) Cybersecurity Analyst Advisor (Content Engineer)

Sep 2023 – Sep 2024

General Dynamics Information Technology

Automation | Customer Outcomes | Incident Response | Security | SOC Leadership | Splunk | Threat Intel

- Served as lead IC for Splunk ES analytic operations and incident response for the TSS managed security platform.
- Developed detections for exploitation attempts, threat behaviors, and high-fidelity correlation searches.
- Operationalized threat intelligence by integrating IOC sources and aligning detection logic to observed adversary tactics.
- Designed and delivered tabletop and micro-tabletop exercises to build SOC analyst skills and response muscle memory.
- Performed lead incident response duties, including triage, scoping, and threat hunting.

(Enterprise) Security Operations at GDIT/CSRA

Feb 2017 – Sep 2023

USGovSOC, Cloud Services, Technology Shared Services

- Shortened for brevity; additional experience available upon request.
- Developed the TSS Computer Security Incident Response Plan.
- Served in SOC Tier I, II, and III roles in managed security services operations since CSRA.

PROJECTS & TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP

(Enterprise) GDIT — Cybersecurity Innovation Lab SME

2026–Present

Agentic SOC | Automation | Splunk

- Innovating security operations to defend against modern threats.

- Developing robust, AI-enhanced architectures and configurations at enterprise scale.
- Optimizing automation for advanced cybersecurity workflows.

(SMB) CPBC — Digital Infrastructure Lead and Finance Team Member

2023–Present

Web | Content Ops | Streaming | Ops Support

- Built and maintained a church website, digital content workflows, and live service streaming architecture.
- Developed automation for schedule updates, event posting, and content publishing driven by structured data.
- Improved SEO, accessibility, and site reliability through continuous refinement and monitoring.

(SMB) Faith & Fire — E-Commerce Website

2024–Present

Web | E-Commerce | Brand & Sales | UX

- Developed an e-commerce presence for handcrafted seasonings and grilling products.
- Built interactive product pages, automated invoicing flows, and order-tracking integration.
- Optimized digital branding, page structure, and mobile responsiveness for online sales.

Various Github Coding Projects

2024 – 2026

Automation | Desktop App | Web Extraction | Security-Oriented Tooling

- **Cloud AI Courses** - A learner platform and marketplace AI and cloud skill-building.
- **AI Cloud Lab** - A terraform-managed AWS lab for running a private AI as a locally hosted model & chatbot on a gpu-based EC2.
- **Files MD** - A simple Markdown file viewer for Windows for when you just need something clean and elegant.
- **GeoVive** - A geospatial intelligence platform powered by public datasets with a robust API, an AppConnect integration feature, and customizable map layers.
- **LaunchPane** - A lightweight, single-file web launcher for organizing and opening web resources from a customizable dashboard.
- **JustAnotherPassword** - A lightweight and privacy-focused Chrome extension that generates secure random passwords locally in your browser.
- **Ghidra Workbench** - A *private*, local-first, browser-based reverse-engineering workbench that connects a browser GUI for the analyst, a local API backend for project/session orchestration, a Ghidra adapter for decompilation and program inspection, and an LLM adapter for local or remote model providers.
- **WordSearchGen** - A customizable, browser-based application for creating, playing, and exporting word search puzzles.
- **Moultrie-Data-Client** - A Chrome extension for developer mode that will collect and index image metadata from an active session within the Moultrie Web App.
- **Scrapeweb** - Electron desktop application using Puppeteer to extract structured metadata from blog articles and documentation pages.